

CM Himanta Biswa Sarma at the launch of Mission Basundhara

3,50,000 files pending in Assam secretariat for years have been digitised for faster disposal; secretariat to go paperless by end of 2022

were also the departments that impacted the people the most. Unfortunately, common citizens felt most hassled in these departments, mostly because they did not know how to access information. For one file to move from one corner to another, they had to make multiple trips to government offices. They often fell into the trap of middle men, who used to hoodwink unsuspecting innocent individuals.

To bring an end to such harassment and usher in an "ease of business" for the common man, Assam government has introduced three mega digital projects—Mission Sadbhavana, Mission Basundhara and CM—Transport Randomised Allocation Networked System (CM-Trans). "As an elected government, our primary job is to deliver service according to the convenience of the people. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has shown us how digital technology can be used provide good governance. We are simply following his footsteps in the service of the nation," says Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma.

The Sadbhavana portal, launched by Sarma on February 1, 2022, aims to clear the backlog of old files piling up for decades at the Assam secretariat. Many of these files are related to pensions and other provisions of senior citizens, who are unable to make frequent trips to the secretariat in Guwahati. Many, particularly from remote locations, were forced to make overnight journey to reach the state capital. But these troubles are now a thing of the past.

People can now upload their file numbers in the portal from the comforts of their homes or a public facilitation centre. They get to know the status of their applications—whether it has been accepted or rejected and on what grounds—within a stipulated time frame. This has completely wiped off the middleman from the process and saved the transportation cost and time of the individuals involved.

Under Sadbhavana Mission, 3,50,000 files in the secretariat have been divided into four categories—category A files which will be permanently archived, category B files which are 12 years old, category C files which are five years old and category D files which are only one year old. Files in category A will be sent to the archive while the remaining files will be sent to the record room. Earlier, there was no record room in the secretariat but now the process to set up a record room near the office of the Assam State Disaster Management Authority has almost been completed. Currently, nearly 80,000 files are being scanned thoroughly and the process of transferring these files to electronic mode is expected to be completed soon. Files will then be passed on from the lower-level officials to the higher-level officials via the e-office portal. Officials will record their notes digitally and files will be cleared electronically.

The government expects the entire secretariat to be paperless by the end of this year. Every officer and employee working in the secretariat

MY LAND, MY RECORD

The Mission Basundhara portal provides nine land related services online

1	Mutation by right of inheritance
2	Mutation after deed registration
3	Partition of undisputed cases
4	Annual patta to periodic patta conversion
5	Reclassification of land less than one bigha
6	Striking out names of persons who are no longer in possession
7	Allotment certificate to periodic patta
8	Legacy data update/rectification
9	Mobile number update of pattadar

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Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma,
Chief Minister, Assam

